"The true sign of intelligence is not knowledge but imagination."
Albert Einstein

EAP 401:INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PORTFOLIO

Lesson Task 3 Booklet

Name:

Student Number:

Class:

IRP LESSON TASK 3: ACADEMIC PARAGRAPH WRITING: DRAFT & REVIEW

Below you will find details and the format of Lesson Task 3, which you will complete in the second hour on Saturday, Week 4. The activity is outlined here for you to review before the class.

TASK OVERVIEW

This activity is designed to evaluate/review your knowledge of paragraph structure and coherence structure while developing your independent academic writing skills by helping you identify your strengths and areas for improvement. It is an in-class task only.

Your work will be assessed on accuracy, appropriateness, clarity and grammatical correctness. Students who do not attend will not be able to complete or submit the task at a later time. You must work with a partner, who will evaluate your paragraphs using the templates on pages 5-6.

WI-FI INSTRUCTIONS

The wi-fi for the classroom will be disabled during most of the second hour of Saturday's class. Please also ensure the wi-fi of your tablet or laptop is in flight mode (turned off) from the beginning of the second hour. Mobile phones should be deposited in pockets provided at the back of the classroom.

TASK AND SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

1. Write ONE OR TWO body paragraphs for one of 4 essay titles. You are not required to include an introduction or conclusion for this activity - focus only on paragraph writing. After completion of your first draft, you should note 4 of the collocations you have used in each paragraph.

2. Be careful to craft a topic sentence that gives the topic + a controlling idea that is neither too general nor too specific.

3. Having completed the first draft and listed your collocations, you should peer review your partner's work.

4. It is recommended that you spend approximately 30 minutes writing the paragraph(s), 10 minutes reviewing your partner's paragraph(s) and 5 minutes amending errors.

5. **All four essay titles will be of a general nature, and will not require specialist knowledge**

6. You should write AT LEAST 130 words in each paragraph. Use your own ideas and relevant support. For this activity, please draw on your own knowledge and ideas only.

7. *You will be assessed according to the quality of your writing and your ability to self-assess and improve your writing quality.*

8. *You may use:*

- An offline monolingual English dictionary
- An offline collocations dictionary (paper or digital without internet access)

9. *You may not:*

- Use online sources or Wi-Fi
- Use AI tools or software (e.g., ChatGPT, Grammarly)
- Use your mobile phone
- Include citations

10. Please complete document in Word format.

11. Upload to Moodle before the end of the class today. Before uploading, please rename your file:

Lesson Task 3 - English name (or Pinyin if you prefer) - student number.'

12. * Any work deemed to have been written using AI will be penalized. The overall grade for Lesson Task 3 will be reduced by a minimum of 10%.

FORMATTING REQUIREMENTS:

- 1.5 or 2.0 line spacing
- A space after each full stop and comma
- Times New Roman Font at 11 or 12 points
- A page number inserted at the bottom of the page

PARAGRAPH REQUIREMENTS:

Each paragraph should include:

- One clear topic sentence
- At least 2–3 supporting ideas
- Appropriate academic collocations
- Logical connectors or reference words for cohesion
- At least 130 words

STUDENT 1: FIRST DRAFT OF BODY PARAGRAPH(S)

Choose one of the following essay titles and write ONE or TWO main-body paragraphs. **Tick ✓ or highlight**:

a) …
b) …
c) …
d) …

This box is for notes only – do not write your essay here

Notes:

Note* A **paragraph** contains relevant supporting ideas.

- A supporting idea can comprise any of the following: *example, evidence, fact, cause/effect, definition, comparison/contrast, recommendation, statistic, argument, quotation, etc.,* to help make the point clear and show how it relates to the topic.

1. Write your first draft here:

Topic sentence:

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Rest of the paragraph:

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Topic sentence:

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Rest of the paragraph:

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2. Which collocations have you used? Note 4 collocations from each paragraph and the form of each word. Academic collocations include:

- *technological advancement* (adj + noun)
- *pose a risk* (verb + noun)
- *benefit from* (verb + preposition)

Paragraph 1

i. .....

ii. .....

iii. .....

iv. .....

Paragraph 2

i. .....

ii. .....

iii. .....

iv. .....

3. STUDENT 1: Exchange the 1st draft of your 2 paragraphs with STUDENT 2

4. STUDENT 2: Complete the peer evaluation pages below and give your name as the evaluator of your partner's paragraphs.

STUDENT 2: PEER EVALUATION OF PARAGRAPHS **Name and ID number of evaluator:**

……...……..…….

1. Evaluate your partner's paragraphs:

a) Scan the paragraph and underline examples of any of the following informal vocabulary:

maybe, get, as we all know, a lot, thing, every coin has two sides, last but not least, what is more, nowadays, more and more, or as we all know, besides, I, you, we, you, us, our, my, or your

b) Underline any contractions *(*for example: *can't, it's, won't, couldn't, don't,* and *didn't).*

c) Is there a clear topic sentence that introduces the main idea for each paragraph? **Yes / No**

d) Are there at least 2 supporting ideas? **Yes / No**

e) Are the supporting ideas relevant to the topic sentence? **Yes / Sometimes / No**

f) Do the supporting sentences contain suitable collocations? **Yes / No**

g) Does the writer use appropriate linking/reference words to help the reader follow the text easily? **Yes / Sometimes / No**

h) Can you see examples of more sophisticated and academic vocabulary? **Yes / Sometimes / No**

i) Does the writer excessively repeat any words? For example? …… **Yes /No**

j) Grammar: **Poor / OK / Good**

k) Spelling: **Poor / OK / Good**

STUDENT 2: PEER EVALUATION OF PARAGRAPHS

GRAMMAR/LEXIS

2. STUDENT 2: Try to find some grammatical/lexical errors in your partner's paragraph. You should indicate which type of error has been made in the paragraph using comments (and track changes if needed). You may wish to use the symbols or abbreviations in the table below. Here is an example of a comment (Ctrl + click on 'esential' to see a brief video clip of the creation of a comment):

3. Note how many errors occur in the table below:

TYPE OF ERROR	Number	TYPE OF ERROR	Number
ww = wrong word		prep = wrong preposition	
number = word should be singular or plural?		art = article should be changed or deleted	
tense = wrong tense		vf = wrong form of verb	
punct. = wrong punctuation		wf = wrong form of word	
informal = informal word used		^ = word missing	
/ = unnecessary word		sp = wrong spelling	
wo = wrong word order		**?** = meaning unclear	
cs = comma splice run-on = run-on sentence		coll = these words do not collocate	
sf = sentence fragment		**?** = meaning unclear	

4. When you have completed the evaluation, please return the document to Student 1

STUDENT 1: FINAL DRAFT OF PARAGRAPHS

1. Review the evaluation made by Student 2.
2. Based on the evaluation of your partner, you should now write a final draft. Please copy and paste your original draft into the "Final Draft" section and make improvements using the **Track Changes** feature in Word. If you are not sure how to use track changes, please ask me.

FINAL DRAFT

3. **Final comments by reviewer:**

What are the strengths of this student in terms of academic writing skills?

1. ..
2. ..

Where can this student make improvements in the future?

3. ..
4. ..